

PORTABLE GENERATOR SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Portable generators create both electrical and combustion hazards.

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Prevent electric shock, carbon monoxide exposure, fire and fuel hazards during portable generator use.

KEY HAZARDS

1  Electric shock.	2  Carbon monoxide.	3  Fuel fire.	4  Hot surfaces.
5  Damaged cables.	6  Incorrect grounding.	7  Water exposure.	8  Noise.

CRITICAL POINTS TO VERIFY IN THE FIELD

01

Electric shock.

02

Carbon monoxide.

03

Fuel fire.



REMEMBER — SERNEM

S

Stop and think

E

Evaluate the risk

R

Remove or reduce

N

Never assume

E

Ensure protection

M

Monitor and communicate

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FIELD REQUIREMENTS AND VERIFICATION

Prevent electric shock, carbon monoxide exposure, fire and fuel hazards during portable generator use.

SERNEM FIELD 01

FIELD VERIFICATION 1

Location suitable

SERNEM FIELD 02

FIELD VERIFICATION 2

Ventilation adequate

SERNEM FIELD 03

FIELD VERIFICATION 3

Grounding suitable

SERNEM FIELD 04

FIELD VERIFICATION 4

RCD installed

VERIFICATION BEFORE START

☐ Location suitable

☐ Ventilation adequate

☐ Grounding suitable

☐ RCD installed

☐ Cables sound

☐ Water controlled

SUPERVISOR DISCUSSION POINTS

- Where will the generator be located?
- Is grounding suitable?
- Is RCD protection installed?

FIELD APPLICATION



Portable generators create both electrical and combustion hazards.



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CRITICAL CONTROL MEASURES

1. ELIMINATE / REDUCE THE RISK

Position generators outdoors with ventilation. • Protect equipment from water. • Direct exhaust away from workers.

2. ENGINEERING & PHYSICAL CONTROLS

Verify grounding requirements. • Stop and cool the engine before refuelling. • Apply hearing protection.

3. WORK METHOD & FIELD CONTROLS

Use RCD/GFCI protection. • Store fuel in approved containers.

4. PPE, VERIFICATION & SUPERVISION

Inspect electrical leads. • Provide fire extinguishers.

CRITICAL WARNING



Team, a generator is not just a power source. We will control exhaust and carbon-monoxide exposure, verify electrical protection, keep fuel away from hot equipment and position the unit safely away from occupied areas.

SITE CHECKLIST — BEFORE STARTING WORK

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Location suitable | ☐ Ventilation adequate |
| ☐ Grounding suitable | ☐ RCD installed |
| ☐ Cables sound | ☐ Water controlled |
| ☐ Fuel safe | ☐ Extinguisher available |
| ☐ Exhaust safe | ☐ Crew briefed |



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ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

Project / Site: _____ Date: _____

Presented by: _____ Work area: _____

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			